

December

24

1818

Silent Night

Joseph Mohr and Franz Xaver Gruber gave the first performance of *Silent Night*, which has since become a favourite of Christmas carol singers around the world.



Born this day

1868 Emanuel Lasker, German chess player. He was the World Chess Champion from 1894 to 1921.

1956 Anil Kapoor, Indian actor. He has starred in many TV series and films, including *Mr India* and *Slumdog Millionaire*.

1943

Supreme commander

As World War II raged, US general Dwight D Eisenhower was put in charge of Operation Overlord – the planned Allied invasion of territory occupied by Germany. After the war, Eisenhower went on to be elected US president in 1953.



Also on this day

1801 British inventor **Richard Trevithick** showcased his steam-powered vehicle – the first of its kind that could carry passengers.

1893 **Henry Ford** – founder of the Ford car company – successfully tested his first engine invention.

1968 **US astronauts aboard Apollo 8** became the first humans to enter the Moon's orbit.



Inventing the phonograph

1878

US inventor Thomas Edison filed an application to patent his latest invention, the phonograph. This new device was capable of recording sound onto metal cylinders and playing it back.